Tempers

How a character fights and when they run: every figure the engine applies

Kingdoms Call reference sheet. Data file v2026.10.15-1202. Generated 2026-10-19 from the repository (branch at that date). Numbers are what the engine uses today, read straight from its tables; where a figure comes from the rulebook text instead, the section says so.

Temper governs personal combat: duels, encounters and lair fights. One table in the data file drives every temper effect in the game. This sheet shows that table raw, then the derived figures the rulebook quotes, then the special trait of each temper and the items that change a temper.

What to look for when reviewing

- Is each temper worth choosing? Berserk is all offence, Brave the complete soldier, Cautious the hardest to kill, Cowardly the best archer and thief.
- Cautious and Cowardly heroes break off below 40% HP, so they clear lairs less often; is that trade clear enough to players?
- The "None" profile exists only for lair guardians (no perks, no flight).

Where this comes from

- Data file: TEMPER_TRAITS, KC_TEMPERS. Engine: personal-combat/*. Rulebook: Personal Combat & Temper.
- Items: ALL_MAGIC_ITEMS_P entries with effect.stat = temper.

The raw table (TEMPER_TRAITS)

Trait	Berserk	Brave	Cautious	Cowardly	None (guardians)	Meaning
Melee to-hit bonus (%)	18	12	0	-4	0	Added to the character's own melee to-hit.
Archery to-hit bonus (%)	0	8	0	22	0	Added to the character's own archery to-hit.
Guard (%)	-10	4	14	6	0	Subtracted from anyone attacking them in melee; also lowers the 80% melee ceiling against them.
Melee damage bonus	3	1	0	0	0	Flat bonus to melee damage dealt.
Damage soak	0	0	2	0	0	Flat reduction on incoming melee damage (never below 1).
Hit soak (fraction)	0.12	0	0	0	0	Fraction of each incoming melee or archery hit shrugged off.
Break-out modifier (%)	-10	0	10	15	0	Added to breaking out of melee back to firing range.
Steal modifier (%)	0	0	0	15	0	Added to Steal attempts.
Flee modifier (%)	-20	10	20	30	0	Added to flee attempts (base 30%).
Looks to flee below (fraction of max HP)	0.15	0.25	0.4	0.4	0.25	HP fraction below which they look for a way out.
Chance per round of bolting	0.2	0.3	0.35	0.4	0	Chance per round of acting on that impulse once below the threshold.
Only while losing	False	True	False	False	False	Considers flight only while behind on HP.
Second wind (fraction of max HP)	0	0.26	0	0	0	Recovered once per fight on first dropping below fleeAt + 5%.
Riposte chance	0	0	0.4	0	0	Chance to counterattack when a melee attack on them misses.
Opening shot	False	False	False	True	False	The first move up to firing range in a fight cannot fail.

Trait	Berserk	Brave	Cautious	Cowardly	None (guardians)	Meaning
Begs for mercy	False	False	False	True	False	May beg for mercy when felled instead of dying.
Rage HP	None	None	None	None	None	Extra HP gained for the fight (unused: null for every temper).

Derived figures (as the rulebook quotes them)

Figure	Berserk	Brave	Cautious	Cowardly	Notes
Highest melee to-hit anyone can reach against them	80%	76%	66%	74%	80% cap less the guard
Flee chance (30% + modifier)	10%	40%	50%	60%	+25% against a slow guardian, −15% against a fast one; Invisibility +30; Charm doubles
Second wind triggers below	—	30% HP	—	—	fleeAt + 5%, once per fight, recovers 26%
Melee damage	1–3 + ceil(Melee/2) + 3	1–3 + ceil(Melee/2) + 1	1–3 + ceil(Melee/2)	1–3 + ceil(Melee/2)	Less what a guarded foe soaks (Cautious 2); mithril −2
Incoming melee/archery hit	×0.88	×1	−2 (melee only)	×1	No attack ever reduced below half of what it would have dealt
Mercy when felled	no	no	no	yes	Spared 75% by Good/Divine/Druidic, 50% Neutral/Pagan, 20% Evil/Undead; escapes with 1 HP, hands over a random item; never against a lair guardian

The special trait of each temper

Temper	Trait	What it does	Best at	Weak at
Berserk	Rage	+3 damage on every melee hit; shrugs off 12% of every incoming melee or archery hit. No guard, no soak, no second wind; every attacker gets +10% against them.	Killing fast; melee duels	Dying fast; fleeing (10%)
Brave	Second Wind	+1 melee damage; once per fight, the first time they drop below 30% HP they recover 26% of max HP. Only consider flight while behind on HP.	The complete soldier; lairs	Nothing in particular
Cautious	Guarded and Riposte	Every incoming melee hit reduced by 2; when a melee attack on them misses, 40% chance of a free melee blow. No attack bonus.	Surviving; punishing wild attackers	Clearing lairs (breaks off at 40%)
Cowardly	Opening Shot and Beg for Mercy	First move to firing range always succeeds and they loose a shot first; +22% archery to-hit; +15 Steal; may plead for their life when felled.	Archery, theft, spying; a king you cannot lose	Melee (−4); lairs (breaks off at 40%)

Items that change a temper

Item	Slot	Tier	Sets temper to	Description
Warmask of the Red Rage / Visored Kettle-Hat	helm	2	Berserk	While equipped your temper becomes Berserk in all personal combat.
Bloodstone Torc	amulet	2	Berserk	While equipped your temper becomes Berserk in all personal combat.
Lionheart Pendant	amulet	2	Brave	While equipped your temper becomes Brave in all personal combat.
Circlet of Valour / Visored Barbute	helm	2	Brave	While equipped your temper becomes Brave in all personal combat.
Ring of Second Thoughts / Twisted Thumb-Ring	ring	2	Cautious	While equipped your temper becomes Cautious in all personal combat.

Item	Slot	Tier	Sets temper to	Description
Cloak of Measured Steps / Grey Greatcloak	cloak	2	Cautious	While equipped your temper becomes Cautious in all personal combat.
Hare-Foot Charm / Twisted Finger-Ring	ring	2	Cowardly	While equipped your temper becomes Cowardly in all personal combat.
Craven's Amulet	amulet	2	Cowardly	While equipped your temper becomes Cowardly in all personal combat.

Temper is chosen for the king at founding and for each heir; a hero's temper is rolled. A character auto-equips items, so a found temper item changes a hero's temper unless unequipped.

Gaps, questions and things to check

These are observations from reading the data files, the engine and the rulebook together. None of them is a ruling. Each is a question for Toby or a place where two sources disagree.

#	Observation
1	rageHp is null for every temper: a field the table carries but nothing uses. Remove it or give Berserk a rage pool.
2	Cautious has no attack bonus at all and relies on the 40% riposte; against a guardian that rarely misses (keen eye +20%) it has nothing. Check Cautious heroes' lair results in the Hunting Rumours odds.
3	Cowardly is the only temper with mercy, which hands the victor a random item; a Cowardly king carrying relics is a relic donor. Is that intended?
4	The rulebook says Brave's second wind triggers "below 30%" while the table says fleeAt 0.25 + 0.05; the two agree, but the figure is derived rather than stored. Store it or keep the note.
5	The temper items are all Weak-tier field kit (a temper is utility, not combat kit under R-051). A Powerful-tier temper item with a second effect may be wanted.
6	The "None" profile has fleeAt 0.25 but fleeUrge 0, so guardians never flee; fine, but any future "neutral hero" temper would need its own row.